

Xinzhi Rao

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Last updated on August, 2026

Education

Warrington College of Business, University of Florida, Gainesville, FL, USA - Ph.D. in Business Administration (Information Systems) - Committee: Liangfei Qiu (Chair), Jingchuan Pu (Co-Chair), Anuj Kumar	2022 – 2027 (expected)
Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA, USA M.S. in Statistics	2020 – 2022
University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO, USA B.A. in Mathematics; B.A. in Economics	2015 – 2019

Research Interests

Topics: Digital Platforms, Creator Economy, Generative AI, Online Education
Methods: Causal Inference, Deep/Machine Learning, Experiment Design

Publications

1. “[How Generative AI Transforms Questioning Behavior on Q&A Platforms: Evidence from A Natural Experiment with Pilot Usage of ChatGPT](#)”, **Xinzhi Rao**, Guohou Shan, Michael Rivera, Liangfei Qiu and Nan Wang, *MIS Quarterly*, Forthcoming (UTD 24, FT 50)

Working Papers

2. “[Content Creator Multihoming and Attention Spillovers Across Platforms](#)”, **Xinzhi Rao**, Jingyan Dai, Yulin Hao, and Liangfei Qiu, *In preparation for submission*
 - **Job Market Paper**
 - Presented at: CIST 2025; POMS Annual Conference 2026; Boston University Platform Strategy Research Symposium 2026 (Long talk); INFORMS Annual Meeting 2026 (Scheduled)
3. “From Ally to Adversary: The Impact of Amazon’s Wholesale Program on Seller Revenue”, **Xinzhi Rao**, Yuan Sun, and Liangfei Qiu, *In preparation for submission*
 - Presented at: POMS Annual Conference 2025
4. “Impact of Course Wait Time and Match on Engagement on Online Educational Platforms”, **Xinzhi Rao**, Anuj Kumar, Tharanga Rajapakshe, and Debjit Roy
 - Presented at: SCECR 2026
5. “Centralization and Sentiment Dampening in LLM-Generated Product Review Summaries”, Jingyan Dai, **Xinzhi Rao**, Anuj Kumar, and Kai Sun
 - Presented at: POMS Annual Conference 2026
6. “Security Vulnerabilities on GitHub (working title)”, **Xinzhi Rao**, Jingchuan Pu, and Brian Lee
 - Data analysis in progress

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Florida

Information Systems and Operations Strategy (Evaluation: 4.3/5.0) Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant, University of Florida

Marketing Analysis (MBA) Summer 2026

Data Analysis for Decision Support Spring 2025

Recitation Instructor, Lehigh University

Basic Statistics Spring 2021

Work Experience

Rebellion Research

Data Scientist MA, USA 2019 – 2020

Professional Service

Ad Hoc Referee: Information Systems Research (ISR), Information & Management, Decision Sciences Journal (DSJ), Journal of Intellectual Capital (JIC)

Conference Reviewer: INFORMS Workshop on Data Science, ICIS, AMCIS, PACIS, HICSS

Conference Session Chair: POMS Annual Conference, 2025 and 2026

Selected Honors and Awards

Northwestern Causal Inference Workshop 2026

BU Platform Strategy Research Doctor Consortium 2026

Department Outstanding Scholarship, *Lehigh University* 2020 – 2022

Dean's List, *University of Colorado Boulder* 2015 – 2016

Skills

Software: Python (PyTorch, scikit-learn, Hugging Face Transformers, PEFT), R, Stata, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Language: English (Fluent), Chinese (Native)

References

Liangfei Qiu (Dissertation Committee Chair)

PricewaterhouseCoopers ISOM Professor
University of Florida Research Foundation Professor
Department Chair
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Anuj Kumar

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Jingchuan Pu (Dissertation Committee Co-Chair)

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